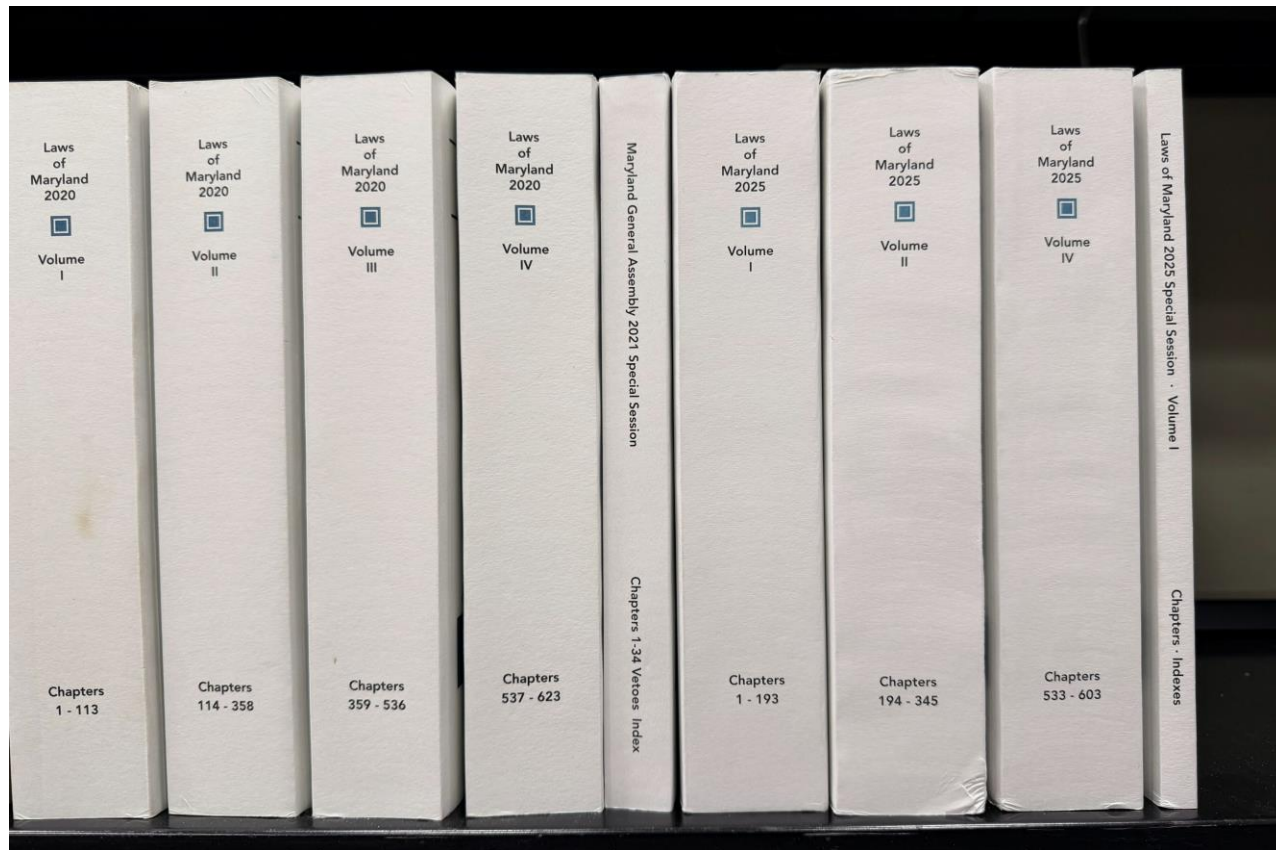


Filling a collection hole

TMSLL collection development policy:

The Library ensures that patrons have access to materials critical to the understanding and practice of law, with particular consideration of Maryland. The collection includes primary source materials from Maryland and its counties and municipalities...





<u>Location</u>	<u>Call Number</u>	<u>Status</u>
Conference Rm	Conference Rm 2025 Vol. IV, Chapters 533-603	Check Shelves
Conference Rm	Conference Rm 2025 Vol. II, Chapters 194-345	Check Shelves
Conference Rm	Conference Rm 2025 Vol. I, Chapters 1-193	Check Shelves
Conference Rm	Conference Rm 2025 Special Session vol. I, Chapters 1-19	Check Shelves
Conference Rm	Conference Rm 2020 Vol. IV, Chapters 537-623	Check Shelves
Conference Rm	Conference Rm 2020 Vol. III, Chapters 359-536	Check Shelves
Conference Rm	Conference Rm 2020 Vol. II, Chapters 114-358	Check Shelves
Conference Rm	Conference Rm 2020 Vol. I, Chapters 1-113	Check Shelves

Maryland ⓘ

Maryland State Legislature

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+ [2020 vol. I \(General Assembly, pp. 1-904\)](#)

+ [2020 vol. II \(General Assembly, pp. 905-1800\)](#)

Filling a collection hole

- [MD Code, State Government, § 2-1254](#)
 - the Department shall deliver copies of the laws, ... to the printer who is designated to print the session laws.
- [MD Code, State Government, § 2-1255](#)
 - The Department shall sell, exchange, or otherwise distribute bound volumes of the laws

You are about to download a "comma-separated values" (CSV) file and/or a JSON file.

The file includes information such as number, sponsor, title, legislative status, synopsis, committee assignments, legislative history, hearing dates, etc for each piece of legislation introduced during the selected legislative session.

A word about the file format: CSV and JSON files are common file formats, widely supported by consumer and business applications and is used to move data between programs. The file you download can be imported into Excel, a text editor, browser, or any other application that supports the CSV and JSON formats. To save, right-click button and save as desired file format.

2026 Regular Session

CSV

JSON

*Updated hourly

2025 Regular Session

CSV

JSON

2024 Regular Session

CSV

JSON

2023 Regular Session

CSV

JSON

2022 Regular Session

CSV

JSON

2021 Special Session

CSV

JSON

2021 Regular Session

CSV

JSON

2020 Regular Session

CSV

JSON

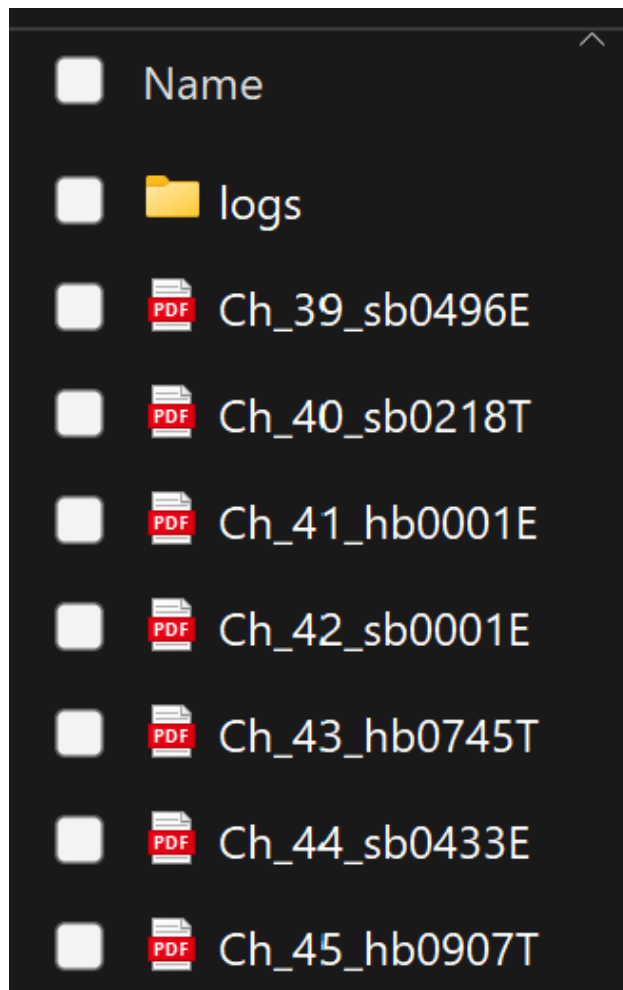
The scraper is looking for specific files on the Maryland general Assembly's website (<https://mgaleg.maryland.gov>). I want to find and download all of the Chapter Laws from the 2021 Regular Session. The scraper should download the PDF files into a file directory. The primary constraint is to not overload the server. I want to rate limit requests to one every 10 seconds

6 previous messages >

Built the first version of the scraper in [🔗 scraper.py](#) and documented how to run it in [📖 README.md](#).

The app is a single-threaded Python CLI that:

- pulls the official 2021 Maryland legislation feed,
- filters for bills whose status indicates a chapter law,
- resolves each chapter PDF from the bill's detail page,
- downloads the PDFs into `downloads/chapter-laws/2021-regular-session`,
- enforces a fixed `10` second delay between requests by default.



```
2026-03-26 11:47:36,419 INFO Starting scraper
2026-03-26 11:47:36,419 INFO Output directory: C:\Users\clssa\Downloads\chapter-laws\2021-regular-session
2026-03-26 11:47:36,419 INFO Manifest path: C:\Users\clssa\Downloads\chapter-laws\2021-regular-session\download_manifest.csv
2026-03-26 11:47:36,419 INFO Log path: C:\Users\clssa\Downloads\chapter-laws\2021-regular-session\logs\run-20260326-114736.log
2026-03-26 11:47:36,419 INFO Status path: C:\Users\clssa\Downloads\chapter-laws\2021-regular-session\run_status.json
2026-03-26 11:47:36,419 INFO Delay seconds: 10.0
2026-03-26 11:47:36,419 INFO Fetching legislation feed from remote URL:
https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/2021rs/misc/billsmasterlist/legislation.json
2026-03-26 11:47:37,145 INFO Found 771 chapter-law candidates
2026-03-26 11:47:37,145 INFO Resolving PDF for bill=sb0496 chapter=39 version=E
2026-03-26 11:47:37,145 INFO Trying direct PDF URL for sb0496: https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/2021RS/chapters_noIn/Ch_39
_sb0496E.pdf
2026-03-26 11:47:46,806 INFO Direct PDF URL worked for sb0496
2026-03-26 11:47:46,828 INFO Downloaded https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/2021RS/chapters_noIn/Ch_39_sb0496E.pdf to C:\Users\clssa
\Downloads\chapter-laws\2021-regular-session\Ch_39_sb0496E.pdf
2026-03-26 11:47:46,828 INFO Resolving PDF for bill=sb0218 chapter=40 version=T
2026-03-26 11:47:46,828 INFO Trying direct PDF URL for sb0218: https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/2021RS/chapters_noIn/Ch_40
_sb0218T.pdf
2026-03-26 11:47:56,831 INFO Direct PDF URL worked for sb0218
2026-03-26 11:47:56,831 INFO Downloaded https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/2021RS/chapters_noIn/Ch_40_sb0218T.pdf to C:\Users\clssa
\Downloads\chapter-laws\2021-regular-session\Ch_40_sb0218T.pdf
2026-03-26 11:47:56,831 INFO Resolving PDF for bill=hb0001 chapter=41 version=E
2026-03-26 11:47:56,831 INFO Trying direct PDF URL for hb0001: https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/2021RS/chapters_noIn/Ch_41
_hb0001E.pdf
2026-03-26 11:48:07,011 INFO Direct PDF URL worked for hb0001
2026-03-26 11:48:07,011 INFO Downloaded https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/2021RS/chapters_noIn/Ch_41_hb0001E.pdf to C:\Users\clssa
\Downloads\chapter-laws\2021-regular-session\Ch_41_hb0001E.pdf
2026-03-26 11:48:07,011 INFO Resolving PDF for bill=sb0001 chapter=42 version=E
2026-03-26 11:48:07,011 INFO Trying direct PDF URL for sb0001: https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/2021RS/chapters_noIn/Ch_42
_sb0001E.pdf
2026-03-26 11:48:17,088 INFO Direct PDF URL worked for sb0001
2026-03-26 11:48:17,088 INFO Downloaded https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/2021RS/chapters_noIn/Ch_42_sb0001E.pdf to C:\Users\clssa
\Downloads\chapter-laws\2021-regular-session\Ch_42_sb0001E.pdf
2026-03-26 11:48:17,088 INFO Resolving PDF for bill=hb0745 chapter=43 version=T
```

How a bill becomes a chapter law

- Bill passed by both chambers and signed (or not) by governor
- Veto override
- Reorganization of executive branch
- Ratification of a constitutional amendment